

# Going Green for Halloween

You don't have to be the Incredible Hulk to go green for Halloween.

All over the nation, Americans are buying spooky supplies for the festivities. While some items need to be purchased every Halloween, other products can last year after year.

There are several different ways to have an environmentally green Halloween. Plus, going green can save you some green in your wallet.

## Save Some Green by Recycling and Reusing Costume Pieces

Costly costumes are often only worn once, making them hard-hitting for the green in your wallet and the green of the planet. Why create so much waste and spend so much money on something that isn't being reused?

Instead of buying a new costume every year, try focusing on key costume pieces that can be accessorized into different ensembles.

Take a simple black dress, for example:

- Add a pointy hat and you've got an instant witch's costume.
- Tie a white apron around your waist and carry a feather duster to create a maid's outfit.
- Or, with the right hairdo and assortment of gadgets, you can turn your black dress into an undercover spy's party gown.

For you guys out there, start off with a nice pair of slacks and matching jacket:

- Create an instant mobster's outfit by adding a fedora, a vibrantly colored dress shirt, and suspenders.
- If you want to go as a mild-mannered reporter, put on a pair of horn-rimmed glasses and carry a notepad.
- To make a police detective's uniform, pin on a shiny badge and attach a pair of handcuffs and a toy gun to your belt.

## Ditch Dumpster-Bound Decor and Make Your House Scary Green

People pull out all the rubber graves, ghouls, and ghosts when it comes to making their homes frightening. While having the scariest house on the block rocks, it's easy to break your budget. Not to mention the amount of waste you create with packaging and single-use decorations.

Here are some hot shopping tips for super-scary and super-green decorations:

**1. Use a List to Avoid Double Trouble**

People buy more decorations if items are on sale. Don't give in to the sales sirens! Make a list of the Halloween decorations you currently own and avoid buying duplicates.

**2. Reanimate Your Decorations Year after Year**

Instead of always buying new decorations, consider sturdy decorations that will last for years. Try to buy decorations that store well. Increase the life of your decorations by storing them in festive plastic coffins, (AKA, black and orange storage bins with tight-fitting lids).

**3. Steer Clear of the Single-Use Trap**

Banners, streamers, and confetti, look nice, but they disintegrate shortly after you put them up. Plus, they really aren't a good investment for your wallet or the environment.